2.1 Pre-operative Care

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I am afraid I will not wake up after the operation." • Says he slept badly the night before surgery **Objective** • HR 104/min, BP 138/88 mmHg • Restless, keeps asking questions • Hands trembling	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to anticipated surgery and unfamiliar environment as evidenced by verbalized fear, restlessness and tachycardia.	He tells you he feels less anxious before he goes to theatre. HR back to his baseline within 2 hours.	• Ask how anxious he feels and what exactly frightens him. • Walk him through what happens before, during and after surgery, in plain words. • Give him time to ask questions and say how he feels. • If policy allows, let a relative stay with him until transfer. • Show him how to breathe slowly and deeply. • Give the prescribed pre-medication and note how he responds.	He says he feels calmer and HR is at baseline: **goal met**. Still very anxious? Tell the surgeon or anesthetist.
Subjective • "I do not know what will happen after surgery." • Asks if he is allowed to eat in the morning **Objective** • Cannot explain the fasting instructions • Cannot show you deep breathing or coughing	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to lack of exposure to perioperative routines as evidenced by questions and inaccurate statements about preparation.	Before surgery he can tell you his fasting time and the pre-op instructions. He can show you deep breathing, coughing and leg exercises.	• Find out what he already knows and how he learns best. • Tell him when to stop eating, and to take off jewellery, dentures and nail polish. • Teach deep breathing, coughing while splinting the incision, and leg exercises, then watch him do them back. • Explain the pain scale, and tell him analgesia will be there for him after the operation. • Go through the pre-op checklist and make sure the consent is signed.	Repeats the instructions correctly and does the exercises: **goal met**. Teaching not finished? Go over it again and bring the family in.
Subjective • Diabetic for 8 years • Smokes 15 cigarettes a day **Objective** • Blood glucose 190 mg/dL • Booked for abdominal surgery • BMI 32 kg/m²	**RISK** **Risk for surgical site infection** as evidenced by risk factors: diabetes mellitus, smoking, obesity and planned surgical incision.	No SSI: wound clean, no redness or discharge, normal temperature for 30 days after surgery.	• Check blood glucose as ordered and report anything above target. • Ask him to shower with antiseptic soap, following policy. • Do not shave the skin; if hair has to come off, use clippers. • Make sure the prophylactic antibiotic is given within the ordered time before incision. • Encourage him to stop smoking, both before and after the operation.	No sign of infection while he is in hospital: **goal met**. Fever, redness or discharge from the wound should be reported straight away.